

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 9 7
♥ Q 10 9 6
♦ J 9
♣ J 10 6 2

♠ A K 5 2

♥ A K 4 3

♦ 7 5 3

♣ 9 5



♠ Q 10 6 4

♥ J 8 2

♦ K 8 4

♣ Q 8 3

♠ 8 3

♥ 7 5

♦ A Q 10 6 2

♣ A K 7 4

West	North	East	South
			1 ♦
Pass	1 ♥	Pass	2 ♣
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by North

Lead: ♠ 4

small ♦, finessing with dummy's ♦ Q. Happily this time the finesse works, and even more happily both defenders follow suit. That means the rest of the ♦s are good and you make an overtrick.

This was just a normal suit-establishment Deal.

If looked different because of the two finesses you took.

North is to play 3NT. East leads the ♠ 4.

Winners: ♠=2 ♥=2 ♦=1 ♣=2 Total = 7

You need two more winners. They cannot possibly come from ♠s, ♥s, or ♣s since one defender must hold at least 4 cards in each of those suits. So your two extra winners must come from the ♦ suit.

There is no reason to hold up on the ♠ since the ♥ and ♣ suits also have just two stoppers. You win the ♠ A.

Your best play next is to finesse the ♦ 10. This may gain a trick by virtue of the finesse if East happens to hold the ♦ J, but primarily you are working to establish the ♦ suit. Assume West wins the ♦ J and returns a ♠.

Again don't hold up. Take the ♠ K and lead another

Board 2

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 9 7
 ♥ 4 3
 ♦ 8 6 5 2
 ♣ A 8 6 5 3

♠ A 8 5
 ♥ Q 10 9 6
 ♦ Q J 9
 ♣ 10 7 4



♠ K Q 3
 ♥ A 7 5 2
 ♦ A K 4
 ♣ Q J 9

♠ J 10 6 4 2
 ♥ K J 8
 ♦ 10 7 3
 ♣ K 2

West	North	East	South
Pass	Pass	1 ♣	Pass
2 ♣	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			

3NT by East

Lead: ♠ 4

You were prepared to lose that ♣ finesse to North so you could establish the suit in dummy.

East is to play 3NT. South leads the ♠ 4. North puts on the ♠ A and returns the ♠ 8.

Winners: ♠=2 ♥=1 ♦=2 ♣=1 Total = 6

Needing three more winners you are going to have to establish the ♣ suit. You are also going to have to be lucky!

You win the second ♠ and play your ♣ Q. South covers with the ♣ K. What do you do next?

You **DUCK**. If you take the ♣ A now you will never get back to dummy to enjoy those other ♣ s. So let South have the ♣ K. You win his return, (probably a ♠), and play ♣ J, then ♣ 9 to dummy's ♣ A. As long as ♣ s split 3-2 you will get the three winners you need.

South's play of the ♣ K may have made you want to jump up with the ♣ A, but you must stick to the original play of ducking one trick.

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ K 10 8 2
 ♥ K 10 4
 ♦ 8 7 2
 ♣ K J 7

♠ 7 5 4
 ♥ A Q 8 7 5
 ♦ 9 6 3
 ♣ 8 4



♠ J 9 6
 ♥ J 9 2
 ♦ Q J 10
 ♣ 10 9 3 2

♠ A Q 3
 ♥ 6 3
 ♦ A K 5 4
 ♣ A Q 6 5

West	North	East	South
	Pass	Pass	1♦
Pass	1♥	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			

Lead: ♠2

Ducking the first ♥ and finessing the second could let you wind up with no tricks at all in the ♥ suit.

But, it is your only chance to make the contract.

South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♠2. East puts on the ♠J.

Winners: ♠=2 ♥=1 ♦=2 ♣=1 Total = 6

You need three more winners. It is possible your fourth ♦ can be established, but that needs a 3-3 split. It's also possible that the ♣ finesse will work, and also the ♥ finesse. Since you need the ♥ finesse anyway you should go ahead and try to establish the ♥s.

Win the first trick with your ♠Q and play a low ♥, ducking in dummy. East will no doubt win a cheap trick but no matter. When you next gain the lead play your other low ♥ and finesse the ♥Q. Assume this wins (if it doesn't you will be going down for sure). Play the ♥A and if both defenders follow your other 2 ♥s are good and your contract is made.

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ 7 4
 ♥ A Q 8 6 2
 ♦ Q 6
 ♣ A 8 4 3

♠ K Q J 10

♥ 10 9

♦ 7 4 3

♣ K 10 7 2



♠ 8 6 5 3

♥ K 5 4

♦ K J 10 8 5

♣ Q

♠ A 9 2

♥ J 7 3

♦ A 9 2

♣ J 9 6 5

West

1♥

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by West

Lead: ♠K

North

Pass

East

3♥

South

Pass

Some pretty aggressive bidding gets you to a challenging game. West is to play 4♥. North leads the ♠K, overtaken by South's ♠A. South returns a ♠ to North's ♠10, and he then plays the ♠Q.

Losers: ♠=2 ♥=0 ♦=1 ♣=3 Total = 6

With 2 tricks already gone you still have 4 losers. You could consider ruffing the 3 ♣ losers in dummy but that would just create a trump loser even when trumps are splitting 3-2. So it looks like you will have to establish the ♦ suit for discards. You could pull trumps and then play your ♦Q, hoping the defenders will grab their ♦A immediately. But unless they are real novices they will hold it up one round and you'll no longer be able to reach dummy.

The solution is to establish the ♦s before you use up dummy's ♥K.

Ruff the third ♠, then play ♦Q, (which they will duck), and another ♦, (which they will probably take). Win whatever they return, pull trumps ending in dummy, and enjoy your 3 ♦ winners.

If South does not take the second ♦ you continue the suit, and whether you ruff or discard a loser you still make the contract.

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 4 3 2

♥ A 8 2

♦ K J 5

♣ Q 10 7 4

♠ A 7 5

♥ J 7

♦ A 10 8 6 3

♣ A K 5



♠ K 10 8 6

♥ 9 6 3

♦ Q 7 2

♣ J 9 2

♠ Q J 9

♥ K Q 10 5 4

♦ 9 4

♣ 8 6 3

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

2♦

Pass

2♥

Pass

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

Lead: ♠6

trick, then start on ♥s. West will hold up the ♥A for 1 or 2 rounds. When he does win it he will return a ♠ and whether you play the ♠A or a low ♠ East will be able to prevent you from reaching dummy.

But if you win the first trick with the ♠A, then dummy's ♠ Q J will provide a guaranteed entry to the good ♥s.

South's 3♦ bid was a transfer to ♥s, and his 2NT bid showed exactly 5 ♥s with an invitational strength hand. North is to play 3NT. East leads the ♠6, you play dummy's ♠9 and West contributes the ♠2.

Winners: ♠=2 ♥=0 ♦=1 ♣=2 Total = 5

The math is easy - you need 4 ♥ tricks. And you should be able to manage that by driving out the ♥A. But the defenders will probably hold up one or two rounds when you play on ♥s, so you must have an outside entry to dummy.

The ♠ Q J will provide that entry **IF** you make sure to win the first trick with your ♠A as an unblocking move. If you don't do so then East will be able to keep you out of the dummy and away from those good ♥s.

Suppose you allow dummy's ♠9 to hold the first trick, then start on ♥s. West will hold up the ♥A for 1 or 2 rounds. When he does win it he will return a ♠ and whether you play the ♠A or a low ♠ East will be able to prevent you from reaching dummy.

Board 6

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K J 4
 ♥ Q J 10 5 3
 ♦ 7 5 4
 ♣ 8 2

♠ 8 6 3

♥ A 8 2

♦ Q J 9

♣ J 10 7 4



♠ A 10 5

♥ 9 7

♦ A K 6 3

♣ A K 9 5

♠ Q 9 7 2

♥ K 6 4

♦ 10 8 2

♣ Q 6 3

West	North	East	South
			Pass
Pass	Pass	1♦	Pass
1♥	Pass	2NT	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			

3NT by East

Lead: ♠2

Now when you attack ♥s a defensive holdup won't hurt you because you have **TWO** ♠ entries, the ♠J by a finesse and the ♠K.

South is almost certain to hold the ♠Q because his ♠2 opening lead promises an honor and the ♠Q is the only one you don't have.

So the ♠ finesse is an odds-on play to get a second dummy entry.

East is to play 3NT. South leads the ♠2, you play dummy's ♠4 and North plays the ♠8.

Winners: ♠=3 ♥=0 ♦=2 ♣=2 Total = 7

Needing just two more winners it looks straightforward to establish dummy's ♥ suit. Suppose you win the ♠10 and play the ♥9. If the defenders win this trick you are home free. You win their ♠ return with your ♠A, then continue ♥s to drive out their last stopper while you still have the ♠K as a dummy entry.

This won't work against good defenders, who will hold up on the first ♥ trick and win the second. Then when they continue ♠s you won't have another ♥ to return to dummy, so while you can use the ♠K as an entry to establish the ♥s you will never get back to use the good ones.

Instead you should win the first trick with your ♠A.

Now when you attack ♥s a defensive holdup won't hurt you because you have **TWO** ♠ entries, the ♠J by a finesse and the ♠K.